Graph substance · fourteen Mermaid types

Diagrams

When the relationship between things is the message — flow, structure, hierarchy, cause. These are the shapes only a graph renderer draws; anything quantitative has a native chart, and this deck says which.

HOW TO READ THIS DECK

Relationships, not quantities.

One product told two ways: the chart family plots its data, this deck maps its structure — the same Decision Framework, seen as a graph.

orientation · diagram survey

Reach for a diagram when the edges carry meaning

A flowchart's arrows, an ER diagram's cardinality — the connections are the content, not decoration.

Let the diagram own at least half the slide

If the heading dominates and the graph is a sidebar, it is a prose slide with a picture.

The palette drives every stroke automatically

Mermaid pre-renders to SVG with theme tokens injected — dark and accent variants come free.

Quantitative shapes defer to charts

Plans, proportions, positions, boards, and state machines each have a native chart — the last slide maps them.

Group 01 · Flow & sequence

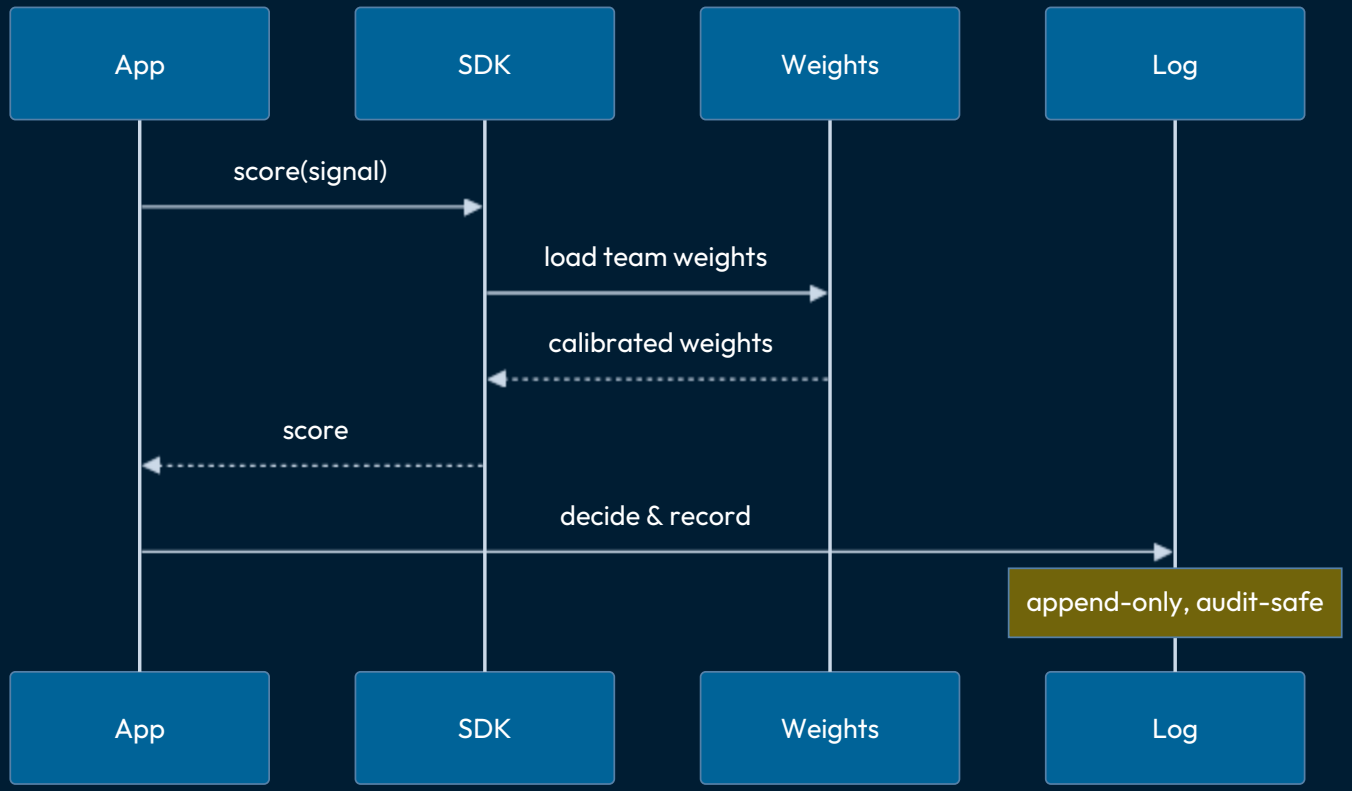
How work moves through the system.

Flow & sequence · Flowchart

How a raw signal becomes a logged decision.

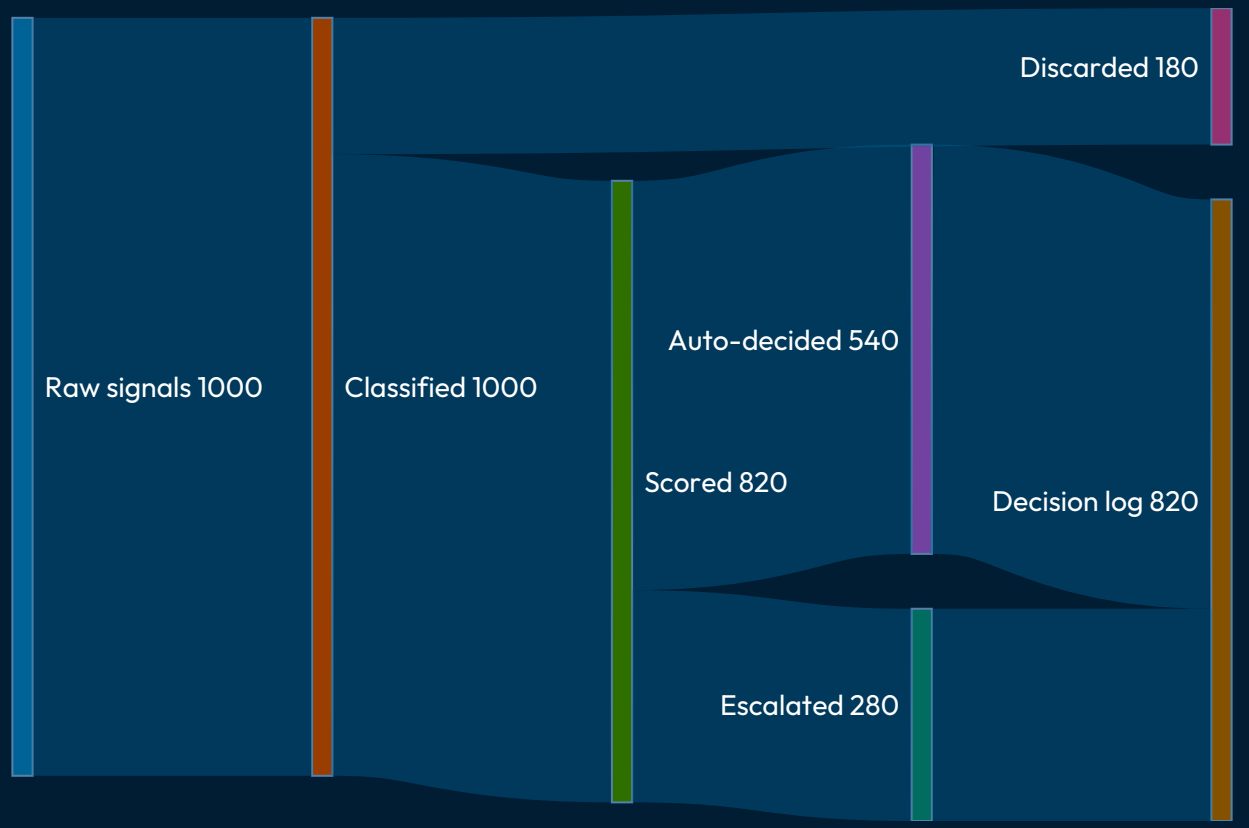


The score-and-decide handshake, actor by actor.



Flow & sequence · Sankey

Where a thousand signals actually end up.

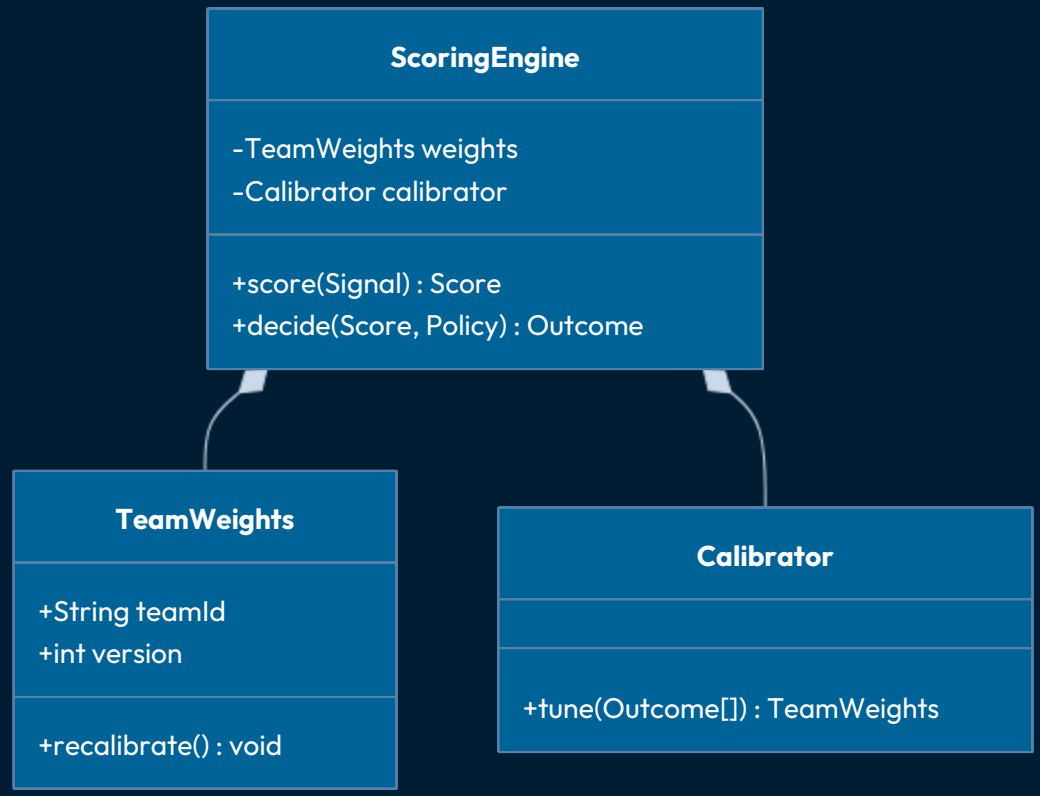


Group 02 · Structure & schema

The shape of the data and the code.

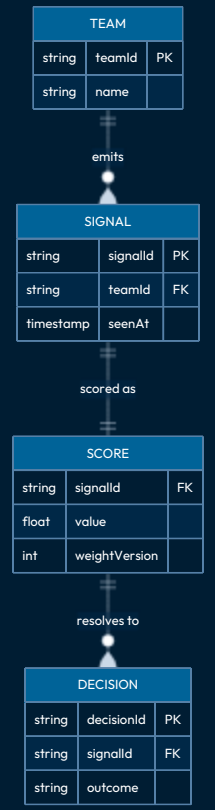
Structure & schema · Class

The scoring engine as an object model.



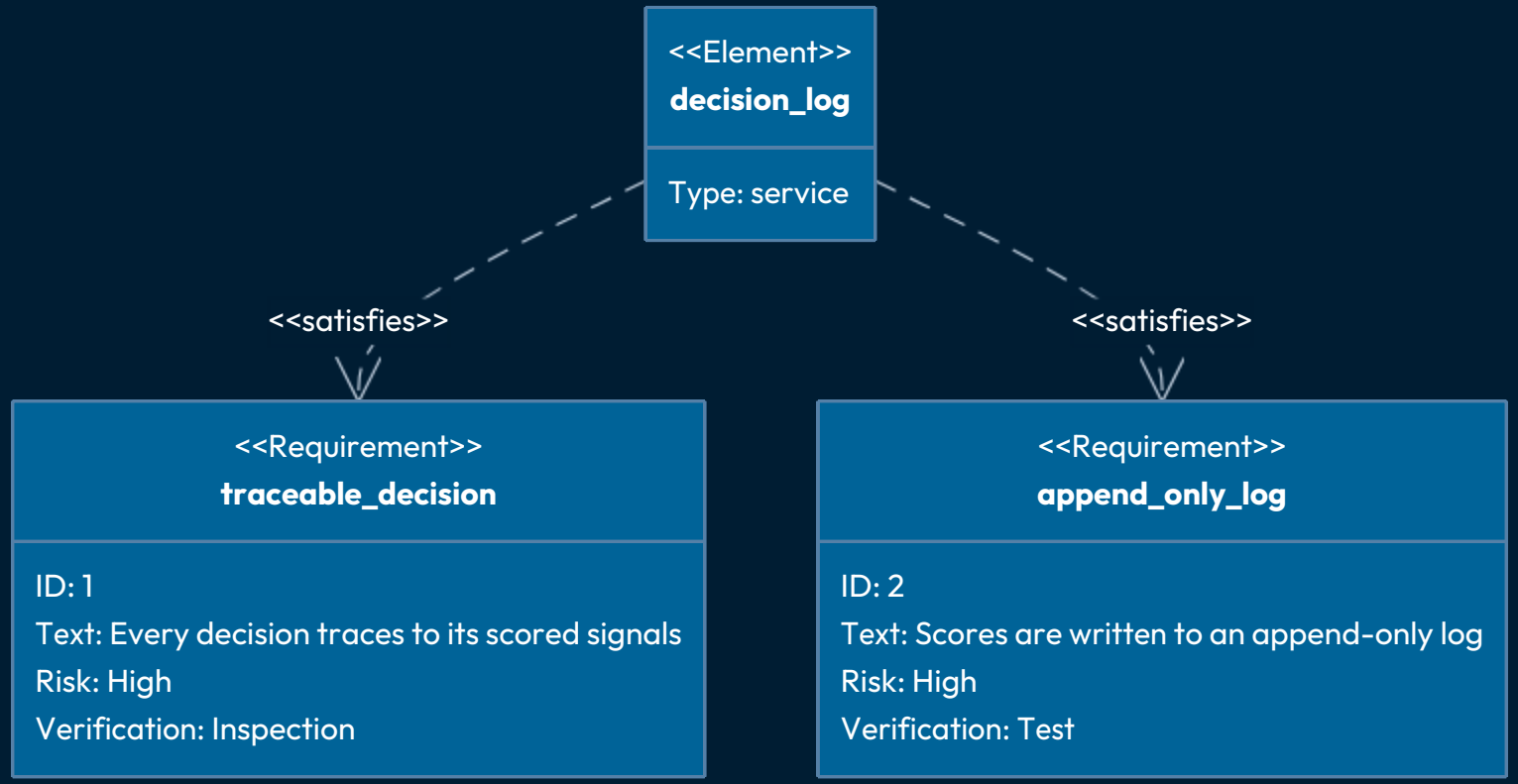
Structure & schema · Entity relationship

The decision log, table by table.



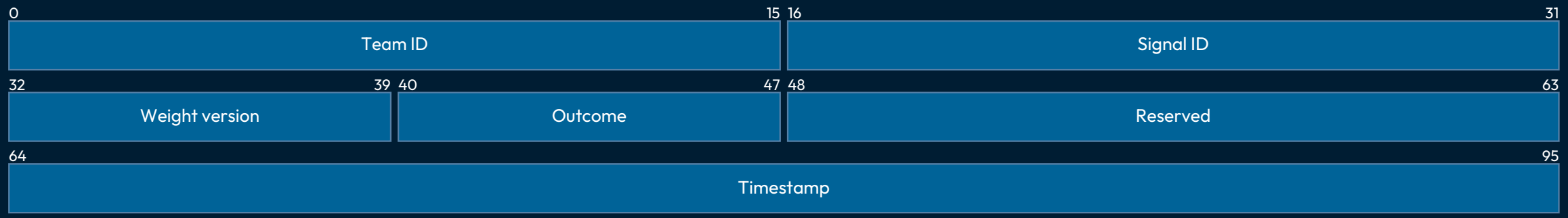
Structure & schema · Requirement

What the audit demands, traced to what satisfies it.



Structure & schema · Packet

One decision-log record, field by bit.

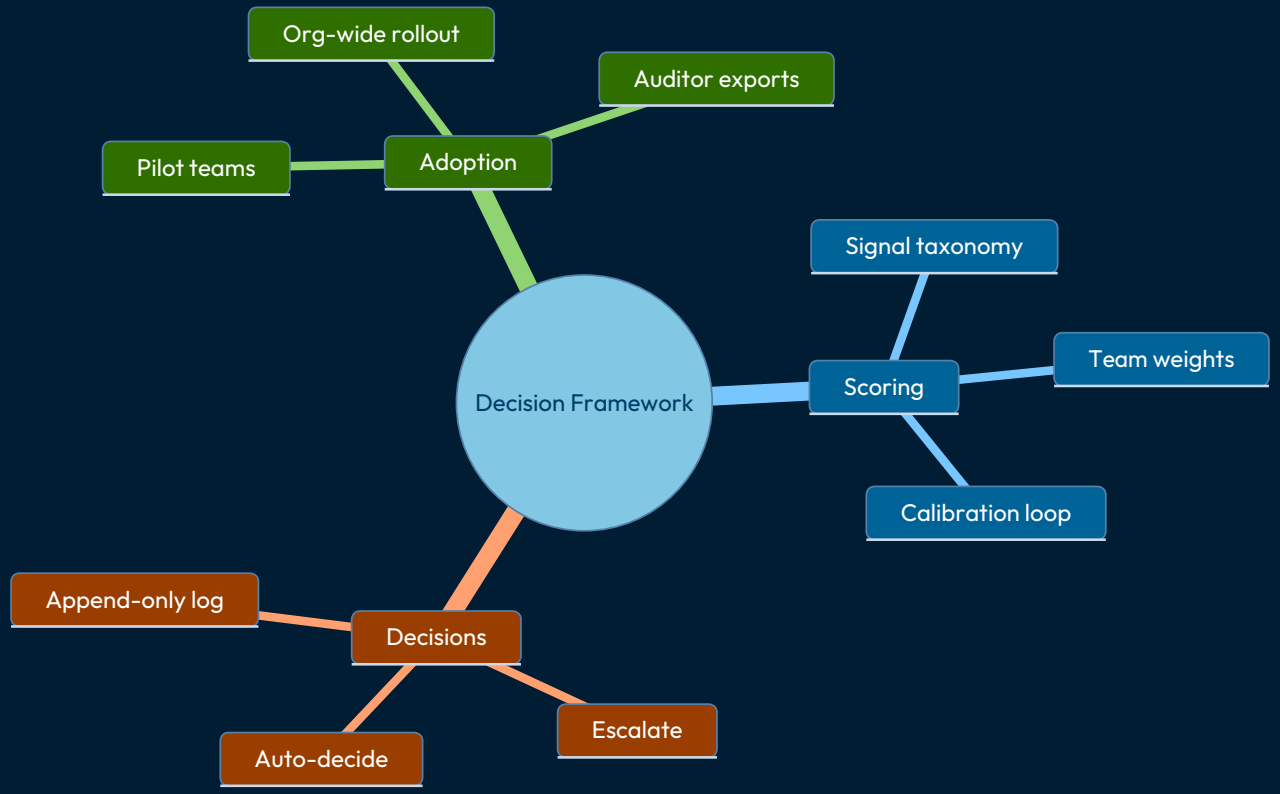


Group 03 · Hierarchy & systems

Wholes broken into parts, and parts wired together.

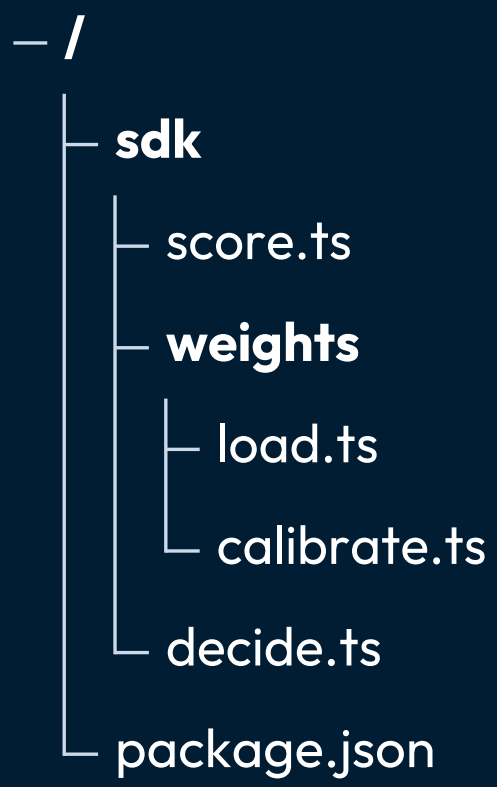
Hierarchy & systems · Mindmap

The whole framework, decomposed on one canvas.

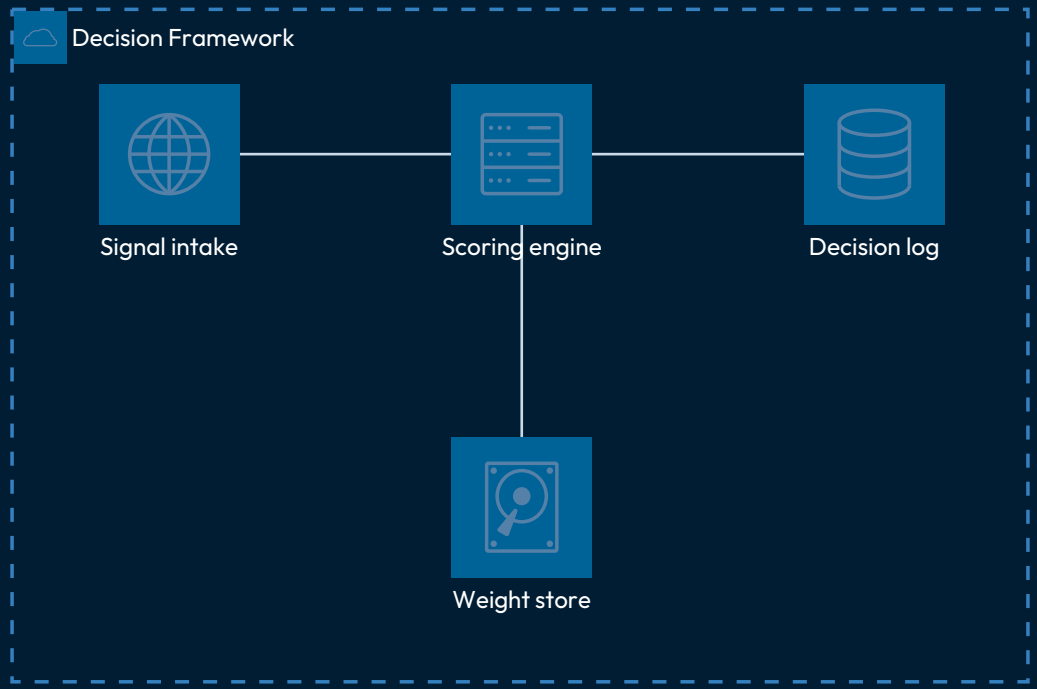


Hierarchy & systems · Tree

The SDK repository, folder by folder.

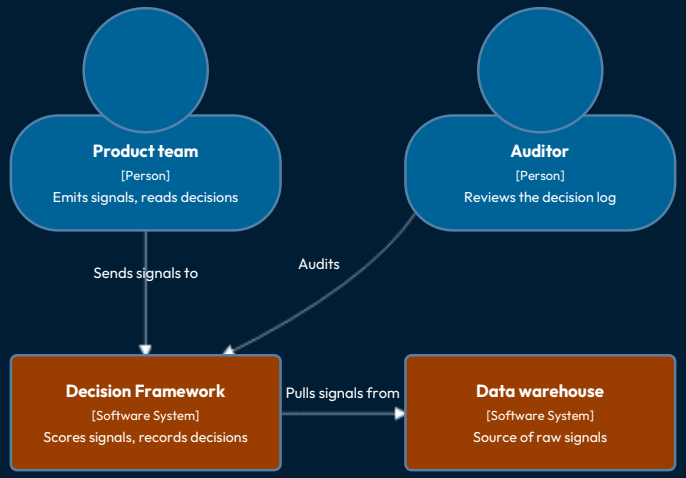


The same system, as deployed services.



Hierarchy & systems · C4 context

Who touches the framework, and how.

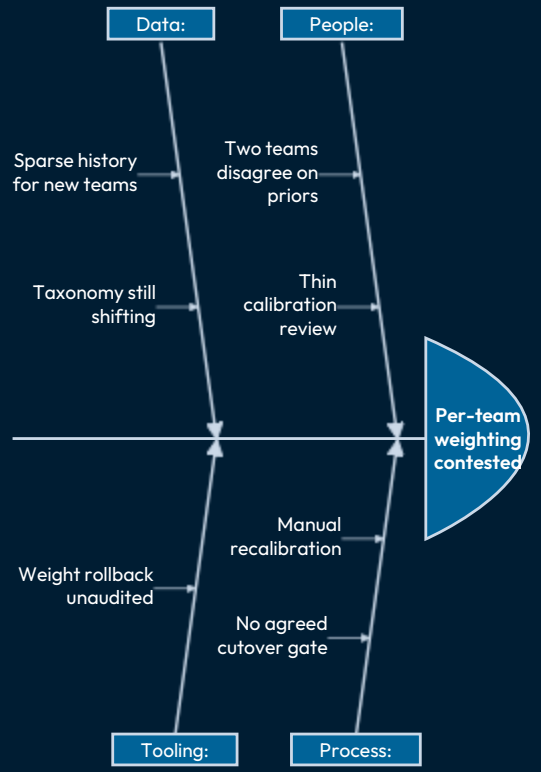


Group 04 · Cause, set & history

Why something happened, what overlaps, and what shipped.

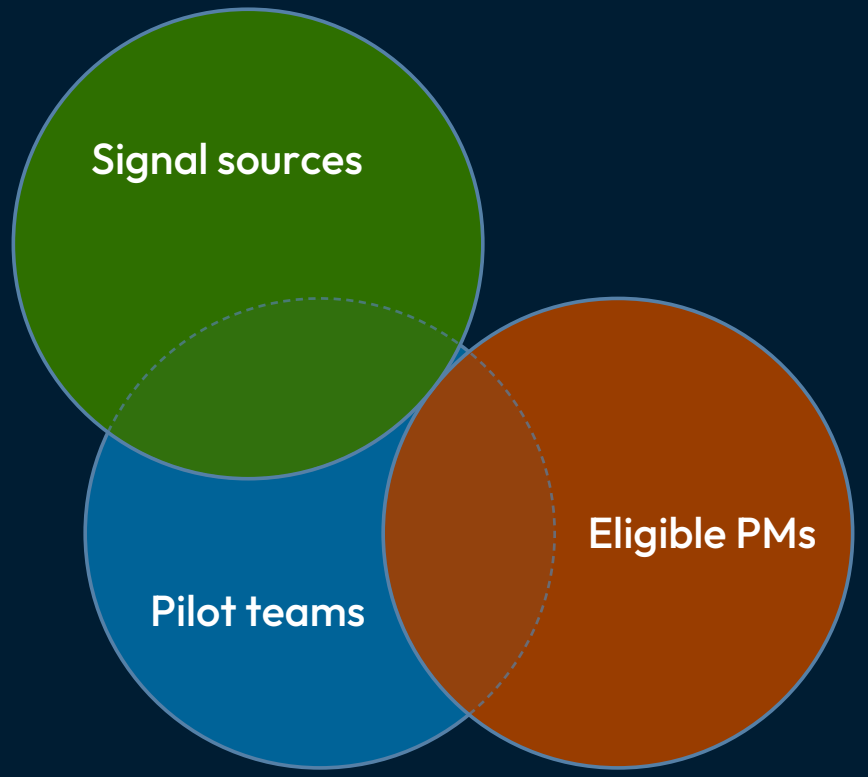
Cause, set & history · Ishikawa

Why per-team weighting stalled — the fishbone.



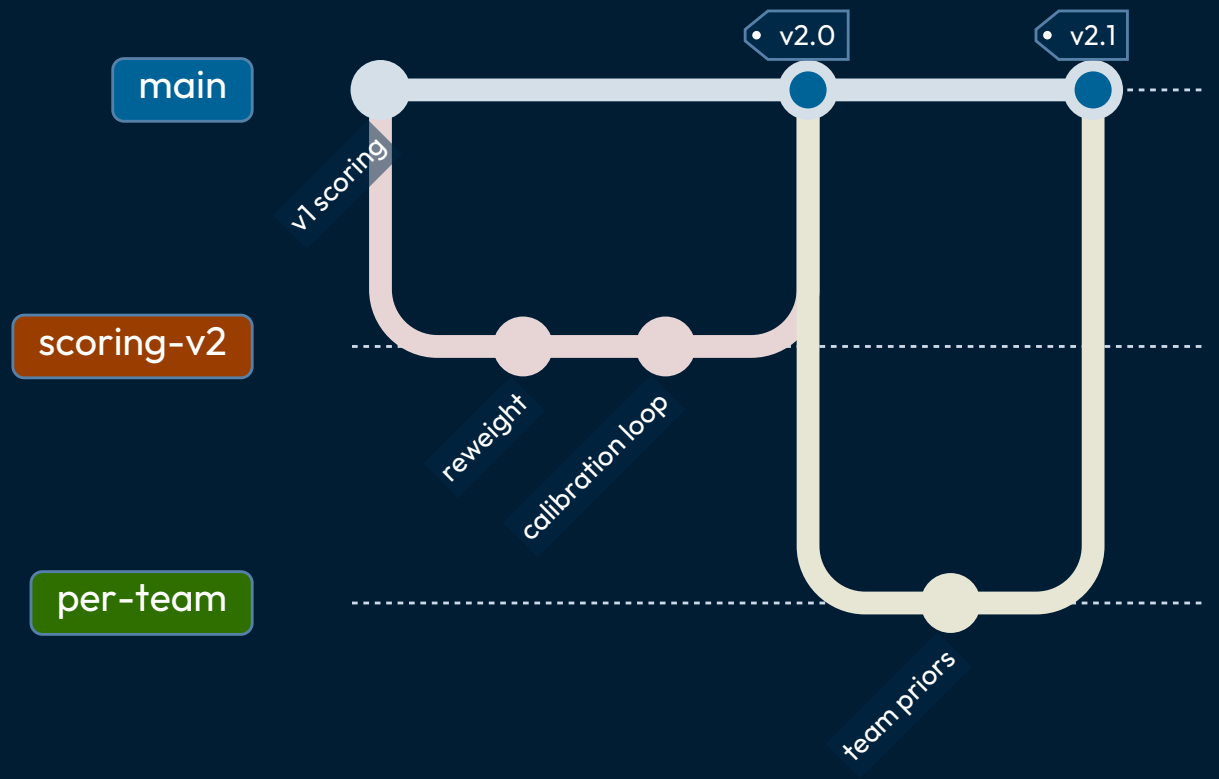
Cause, set & history · Venn

Where the pilot audiences overlap.



Cause, set & history · Git graph

How the scoring model reached v2.1.



The chart handoff

When the shape is quantitative, use a native chart.

These shapes exist as both a Mermaid diagram and a native SVG-kernel component. Prefer the native one — it is themeable through tokens, lighter (no external renderer), and export-clean.

WHEN YOU HAVE…	MERMAID WOULD DRAW	PREFER THIS NATIVE COMPONENT
A dated plan or sequence of moments	gantt, timeline, journey	`gantt` · `timeline-list` · `roadmap` · `journey`
A proportion or a position on axes	pie, quadrant, radar	`piechart` · `quadrant` · `radar`
A board or a state machine	kanban, stateDiagram	`kanban` · `state-chart`

Diagrams · graph substance

Reach for a diagram when the graph is the slide.

Fourteen relational shapes, one palette, one product. For plotted data — proportions, positions, dated plans, boards — the native chart family renders it lighter and fully themeable.